

Psalms 50

The Mighty God Hath Spoken

The mighty God, even the Lord, hath spoken

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *The mighty God, even the LORD, hath spoken, and called the earth from the rising of the sun unto the going down thereof.*
- 2 *Out of Zion, the perfection of beauty, God hath shined.*
- 3 *Our God shall come, and shall not keep silence: a fire shall devour before him, and it shall be very tempestuous round about him.*
- 4 *He shall call to the heavens from above, and to the earth, that he may judge his people.*
- 5 *Gather my saints together unto me; those that have made a covenant with me by sacrifice.*
- 6 *And the heavens shall declare his righteousness: for God is judge himself. Selah.*
- 7 *Hear, O my people, and I will speak; O Israel, and I will testify against thee: I am God, even thy God.*
- 8 *I will not reprove thee for thy sacrifices or thy burnt offerings, to have been continually before me.*
- 9 *I will take no bullock out of thy house, nor he goats out of thy folds.*
- 10 *For every beast of the forest is mine, and the cattle upon a thousand hills.*
- 11 *I know all the fowls of the mountains: and the wild beasts of the field are mine.*
- 12 *If I were hungry, I would not tell thee: for the world is mine, and the fulness thereof.*
- 13 *Will I eat the flesh of bulls, or drink the blood of goats?*
- 14 *Offer unto God thanksgiving; and pay thy vows unto the most High:*
- 15 *And call upon me in the day of trouble: I will deliver thee, and thou shalt glorify me.*
- 16 *But unto the wicked God saith, What hast thou to do to declare my statutes, or that thou shouldest take my covenant in thy mouth?*
- 17 *Seeing thou hatest instruction, and castest my words behind thee.*
- 18 *When thou sawest a thief, then thou consentedst with him, and hast been partaker with adulterers.*
- 19 *Thou givest thy mouth to evil, and thy tongue frameth deceit.*
- 20 *Thou sittest and speakest against thy brother; thou slanderest thine own mother's son.*
- 21 *These things hast thou done, and I kept silence; thou thoughtest that I was altogether such an one as thyself: but I will reprove thee, and set them in order before thine eyes.*
- 22 *Now consider this, ye that forget God, lest I tear you in pieces, and there be none to deliver.*
- 23 *Whoso offereth praise glorifieth me: and to him that ordereth his conversation aright will I shew the salvation of God.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalms 50, a psalm of Asaph, pictures a courtroom scene in which “the mighty God, even the Lord” summons the whole earth and calls His own covenant people to judgment. His complaint is not primarily a lack of sacrifices—since He already owns every creature—but empty ritual detached from real thanksgiving and obedience, along with hypocrisy that recites His statutes while keeping company with thieves and adulterers. It closes with a stark choice between destruction and deliverance offered to “him that ordereth his conversation aright.”

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-6

The mighty God has spoken, summoning the earth from the rising to the setting sun; out of Zion, “the perfection of beauty,” God has shined, coming with devouring fire and tempest. He calls heaven and earth to judge His people and gathers His saints, who made a covenant with Him by sacrifice; the heavens themselves declare His righteousness, for God Himself is judge.

Verse 7-11

God addresses His people directly: He will not reprove them for lacking sacrifices, since their burnt offerings are continually before Him; He does not need to take a bull from their house or goats from their folds, for every beast of the forest is His, the cattle on a thousand hills, every fowl of the mountains and wild beast of the field.

Verse 12-15

Even if hungry, He would not need to tell them, since the world and its fullness are already His; He does not eat bulls’ flesh or drink goats’ blood. Instead: offer to God thanksgiving, pay your vows to the Most High, and call upon Him in the day of trouble—He will deliver, and you shall glorify Him.

Verse 16-21

To the wicked, God asks what right they have to declare His statutes or take His covenant into their mouth, since they hate instruction and cast His words behind them; they have consorted with thieves and partaken with adulterers, given their mouth to evil, and slandered even their own brother. Because God kept silence, they wrongly assumed He was altogether like themselves—but He will now reprove them and set the matter in order before their eyes.

Verse 22-23

A closing warning and promise: consider this, you who forget God, lest He tear you in pieces with no one to deliver; but whoever offers praise glorifies Him, and to the one who orders his conversation (manner of life) rightly, He will show the salvation of God.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

God is not interested in ritual performance detached from a life of real thanksgiving, obedience, and integrity; He owns everything already, so sacrifice was always meant to express the heart, not supply His needs. Divine patience (“God kept silence”) is not divine approval, and it will eventually give way to reckoning for those who presume on it.

Application for life today.

Examine whether your own religious practices—giving, singing, attending church—have become ritual performance detached from actual thanksgiving, obedience, and integrity in daily life. Notice the specific charge in verses 16–20: reciting truth about God while excusing sin in your own conduct or relationships. Practice verse 15 directly: call upon God in your actual day of trouble and watch for His deliverance, then follow through on the glorifying response that promises.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Where might your own spiritual practices have become ritual performance rather than genuine thanksgiving and obedience?

2. Is there a way you, like the people in verses 16–20, recite truth about God while excusing inconsistency in your own conduct?

3. What would it look like this week to “order thy conversation aright” (v. 23) in one specific relationship or habit?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).